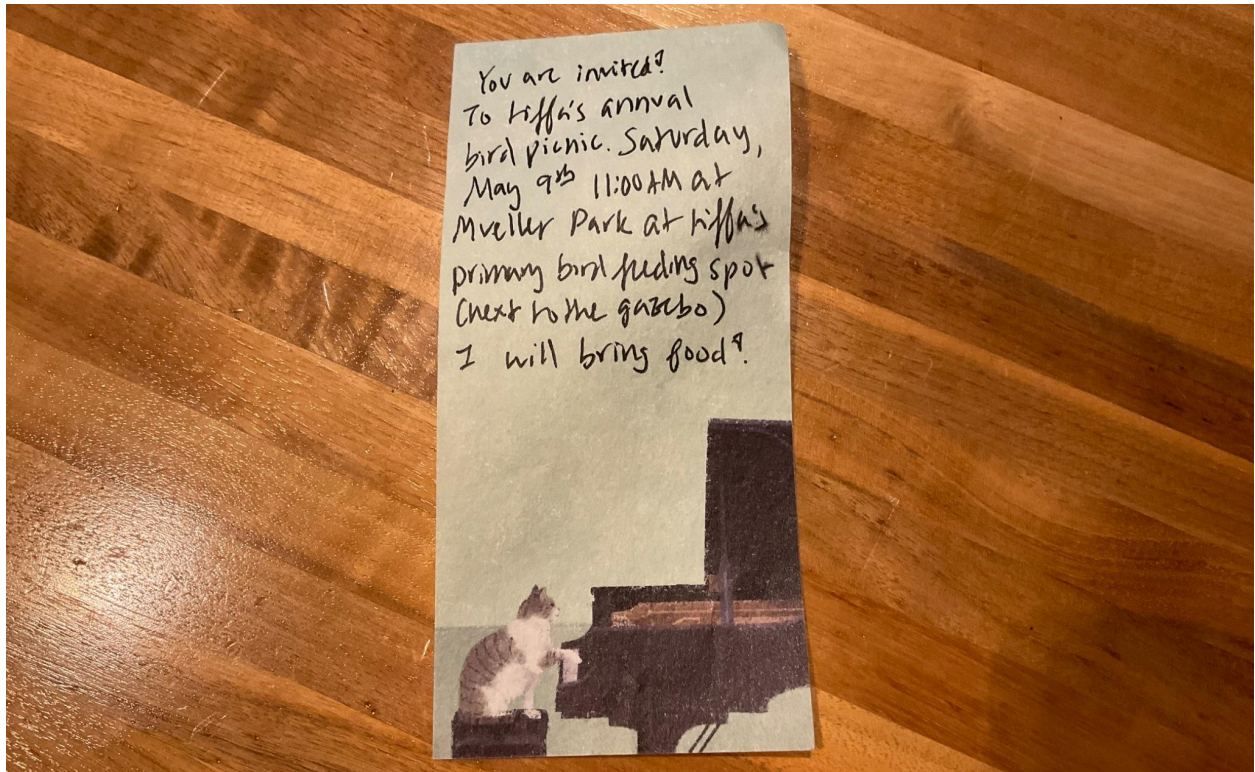


Austin 2: Electric Boogaloo



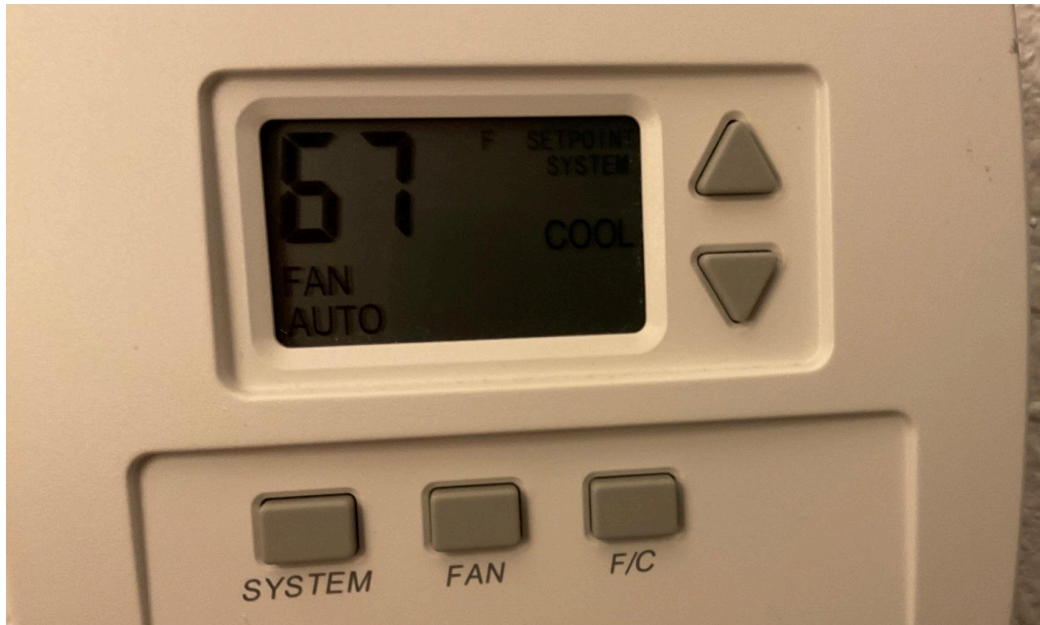
The invitation to touch grass?! I'm shivering my timbers as we speak!!

Picture me after a long day of losing in Valorant and then getting an invitation to a Bird Picnic that same weekend. While in a vacuum I have no problem going, I had a pretty busy April and was actually looking forward to a grass-less weekend. While I was debating the invitation I was given an elevator pitch so good I decided to blow up my chill weekend and start packing.

How I switched up my travel to Austin

After my Austin trip in April I figured out that I do not like the inability to watch Youtube or switching between 4 apps for ~7 hours. While planning the trip I remembered about a bus service called RedCoach that my friends had previously used to go from UT Dallas (in the North suburbs of Dallas) to UT Austin. However I didn't actually check WHERE my bus stop location was until it was too late and I had to make the fun trek downtown Friday evening during peak rush hour. Once I got to Austin I immediately updated my return trip ticket to the correct stop closer to home.

How I switched up my accommodation in Austin



The thermostat when I entered (NOT SCRIPTED)

While the King-sized mattress in a friend's apartment was nice I wanted to engage in some chud-maxxing so I booked a nice hotel using some travel credits. While I knew prices would be higher due to Mother's day I didn't know that UT graduation was also set to be the same weekend so I probably experienced a once-in-a-generation price hike. Luckily my hotel wasn't THAT much higher so I was able to decompress without any thoughts in my head once I was in the hotel room.

The Weekend

Friday night was just preparing for the bird picnic and do not believe ANY of the allegations I can slice tomatoes VERY VERY VERY thin!!! Also you would think that picnic food prep would be relaxing but it was pretty hectic with a lot of words being thrown towards my delicate, dainty, well-defined, thin, and demure tomato "slices".

Saturday was a very busy day so I got up bright and early to start working on a blog post while waiting for my ride to Mueller Park. Once we arrived at the park we lugged some refreshments to the designated bird picnic spot (on time allegedly). The food we made the night before ended up being very tasty and I enjoyed the entire picnic - it helped that I was able to learn about a TFT bug where you can field the stage 5 dragon. Eventually it got too hot and we decided to wrap the picnic up and once I returned to my hotel room I pulled up Cecilia Imergreen's Pikuniku playthrough while I continued to work on the blog. While I don't remember how much work I actually got

done, I can at least confirm that Pikuniku looks like a really fun game and Cecilia is an S tier streamer. Sadly dinner arrived and I had to close the Youtube stream and go to the “legendary” “3 Michelin Star” Chile’s on 47th. While I personally didn’t care that much about the lore behind its claim to fame I was VERY hungry and excited to try the triple dipper meal. Overall I really liked my mozzarella sticks and sliders but I think the buffalo sauce was too salty and made the chicken tenders basically inedible. Very unfortunate because otherwise the meal would’ve been Usagi approved. Filled with 1900 calories I was then ported over to a friend’s apartment where I assumed we would play boardgames but instead we just reviewed my dating profile and now I know that doing a double thumbs up with 3 desserts in front of me makes me look like a “40 year old dad”.

Sunday was pretty chill since I was gonna head back at 3pm and folks wanted to relax before the Monday scaries so we just had fried chicken sandwiches during lunch and then board games at the Emerald Tavern with stinky Catan. Before I talk about stinky Catan I’ll quickly say that I have NEVER heard of someone referring to mac and cheese as [redacted] but it did make the eating experience a lot more interesting. Ok back to Emerald Tavern and I think the concept is pretty cool - host a themed space for board game sessions including food, drinks, and even boardgames. Ignoring the stinky Settlers of Catan game we rented, I did enjoy the establishment and if I had a D&D (or D&D adjacent) group I could see myself regularly meeting there.

Conclusion



quack.

Was it worth it? Did I feel relaxed afterwards? Yeah I don't really regret going on this trip but I just wished I read the initial bus tickets closer because that would've saved a LOT of stress Friday afternoon.

So uh you'd think I'd have some boring blogs coming up after all that talk about wanting chill weekends but you'll probably be reading about my NYC trip next time 😊.